READING COMPREHENSION

Directions (1-8): Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions given below.

They were an odd pair. Albert Camus was French-Algerian, a pied-noir born into poverty who effortlessly charmed with his Bogart-esque features. Jean-Paul Sartre, from the upper reaches of French society, was never mistaken for a handsome man. They were gleaming icons of the era. Newspapers reported on their daily movements: Sartre holed up at Les Deux Magots, Camus the peripatetic of Paris. As the city began to rebuild, Sartre and Camus gave voice to the mood of the day. ____. Readers looked to Sartre and Camus to articulate what that new world might look like. 'We were,' remembered the fellow philosopher Simone de Beauvoir, 'to provide the postwar era with its ideology.'

It came in the form of existentialism. Sartre, Camus, and their intellectual companions rejected religion, staged new and unnerving plays, challenged readers to live authentically, and wrote about the absurdity of the world—a world without purpose and without value.

If the idea of freedom **bound** Camus and Sartre philosophically, then the fight for justice united them politically. They were committed to confronting and curing injustice, and, in their eyes, no group of people was more unjustly treated than the workers, the proletariat. Camus and Sartre thought of them as shackled to their labour and shorn of their humanity. In order to free them, new political systems **must being constructed**.

In October 1951, Camus published *The Rebel*. In it, he gave voice to a roughly drawn 'philosophy of revolt'. This was not a philosophical system per se, but an amalgamation of philosophical and political ideas: every human is free, but freedom itself is relative; one must embrace limits, moderation, 'calculated risk'; absolutes are anti-human. Most of all, Camus condemned revolutionary violence. Violence might be used in extreme circumstances (he supported the French war effort, after all) but the use of revolutionary violence to nudge history in the direction you desire is utopian, absolutist, and a betrayal of yourself

Workers-free
Violence

‘Absolute freedom is the right of the strongest to dominate,’ Camus wrote, while ‘absolute justice is achieved by the suppression of all contradiction: therefore it destroys freedom.’ The conflict between justice and freedom required constant re-balancing, political moderation, an acceptance and celebration of that which limits the most: our humanity. ‘To live and let live,’ he said, ‘in order to create what we are.’

Sartre read *The Rebel* with disgust. As far as he was concerned, it was possible to achieve perfect justice and freedom—that described the achievement of communism. Under capitalism, and in poverty, workers could not be free. Their options were unpalatable and inhumane: to work a pitiless and alienating job or to die. But by removing the oppressors and broadly returning autonomy to the workers, communism allows each individual to live without material want and therefore to choose how best they can realise themselves. This makes them free, and through this unbending equality, it is also just.

M.9

W-

capitalism

communism

Free

30sec

1 min

Question 1.

With which of the following statements about Sartre and Camus is the author most likely to disagree?

disagree

different

A. Sartre and Camus had conflicting views on the proletariat suffering the most from societal injustice.

workers

B. Sartre and Camus were different from each other not only by their physical appearances but also by their social standings.

Agree

C. Sartre and Camus were equal proponents of existentialism.

Agree

supporters

D. Sartre and Camus both wrote about the public sentiment prevailing in post-war Paris.

Agree

E. Sartre and Camus both were contemporaries of Simone de Beauvoir.

Agree

2 Differences

Social status

Looks

Question 2.

independence

Refer to the line: "But by removing the oppressors and broadly returning autonomy to the workers, communism allows each individual to live without material want and therefore to choose how best they can realise themselves." – Autonomy

Which of the following is a logical conclusion that can be derived from this line?

A. A person's financial situation has less of an impact on realising their aspirations than his resolve. determination COOC

B. Communism incorporates a lack of autonomy for the workers. includes independence

C. People cannot achieve their true potential as long as they face financial deprivation.

D. Autonomy in work is the right of everyone.

E. Most often people are not aware of what they truly desire.

d

Question 3

Which of the following best represents the attitudes Sartre and Camus had towards justice and freedom?

A. Sartre and Camus both believed in the unattainability of absolute justice and freedom.

B. Sartre and Camus both supported the view that there should be no limitations to justice and freedom whatsoever.

C. Sartre sought to attain absolute justice and freedom through communism, while Camus wanted to do so through revolutionary violence. condemn 1 min

D. Sartre believed in absolute justice and freedom through communism, while Camus wanted everyone to exercise justice and freedom within appropriate limitations.

E. Sartre believed that limitations to justice and freedom can be eliminated through communism, while Camus held the view that justice and freedom never had any limitations with respect to the workers.

Camus and Sartre thought of them as shackled to their labour and shorn of their humanity. In order to free them, new political systems **must being constructed**.

must + be + v3

Question 4

In the following sentence, correct the emboldened phrase if it is incorrect. If the phrase is correct, select 'no improvement' as your answer.

B

In order to free them, new political systems **must being constructed**.

A. are being constructed

should

B. ought to be constructed

C. No improvement

D. must have been constructed

E. need to being constructed

Task is completed

As the city began to rebuild, Sartre and Camus gave voice to the mood of the day. ____.

Question 5

Which of the following sentences can fit in the blank in the passage?

A. He was appalled by the stories emerging from the USSR: it was not a country of hand-in-hand communists, living freely, but a country with no freedom at all.

B. This division between hardline and moderate leftists—broadly, between communists and socialists—was nothing new.

C. The split between the two friends was a media sensation.

D. Not all leftists, of course, endorsed such violence.

E. Europe had been immolated, but the ashes left by war created the space to imagine a new world.

Question 6

Based on the reading of the passage, what can be said about the French war effort?

copy

A. Its success was replicated in countries outside Europe.

B. It had failed to achieve its objective.

C. It was widely criticised because of its use of violence.

D. Violence was part of this war effort.

E. It had its origins outside France.

d

Question 7

Which of the following best conveys the primary purpose of the author in the passage?

A. To provide a historical context of the French war

B. To convince the reader that Albert Camus was right in his treatment of justice and freedom

C. To compare viewpoints of Albert Camus and Jean-Paul Sartre on justice, freedom, and violence

D. To highlight the divide between different classes in post-war France

E. To outline the achievements of Albert Camus and Jean-Paul Sartre

If the idea of freedom **bound** Camus and Sartre philosophically, then the fight for justice united them politically.

Question 8 Which of the following sentences uses the word '**bound**' in the same way as it has been used in the passage?

I. Between airport security, government surveillance, and tourists taking vacation snaps, you were **bound** to have your picture taken multiple times.

II. Organisations such as schools and clubs in the city have **bound** the community together for decades.

III. He was **bound** by the contract to pay before the end of the month.

A. Only I and II

B. Only II and III

C. Only I and III

D. Only II

E. All I, II, and III

Directions (9-16): Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions given below.

Paragraph 1

School + Tap

When I was a child in the 1950s, my friends and I had two educations. We had school (which was not the big deal it is today), and we also had what I call a hunter-gatherer education. We had time to explore in all sorts of ways, and also time to become bored and figure out how to overcome boredom, time to get into trouble and find our way out of it, time to daydream, time to immerse ourselves in hobbies, and time to read comics and whatever else we wanted to read rather than the books assigned to us. What I learnt in my hunter-gatherer education has been far more valuable to my adult life than what I learnt in school, and I think others in my age group would say the same if they took time to think about it.

H.G →

Paragraph 2

For more than 50 years now, we in the United States have been gradually reducing children's opportunities to play, and the same is true in many other countries. By about 1900, the need for child labour had declined, so children had a good deal of free time. But then, beginning around 1960 or a little before, adults began chipping away at that freedom by increasing the time that children had to spend on schoolwork and, even more significantly, by reducing children's freedom to play on their own, even when they were out of school and not doing homework. Adult-directed sports for children began to replace 'pickup' games; adult-directed classes out of school began to replace hobbies; and parents' fears led them, ever more, to forbid children from going out to play with other kids, away from home, unsupervised.

→ → Freedom / Playtime / Hobbies

Paragraph 3

Over the same decades that children's play has been declining, childhood mental disorders have been increasing. It is not just that we are seeing disorders that we overlooked before. Clinical questionnaires aimed at assessing anxiety and depression, for example, have been given in unchanged form to normative groups of schoolchildren in the US ever since the 1950s. Analyses of the results reveal a continuous, essentially linear, increase in anxiety and depression in young people over the decades, such that the rates of what today would be diagnosed as generalised anxiety disorder and major depression are five to eight times what they were in the 1950s.

→ MD – Depressions

Paragraph 4

The decline in opportunity to play has also been accompanied by a decline in empathy and a rise in narcissism, both of which have been assessed since the late 1970s with standard questionnaires given to normative samples of college students. Empathy refers to the ability and tendency to see from another person's point of view and experience what that person experiences. Narcissism refers to inflated self-regard, coupled with a lack of concern for others and an inability to connect emotionally with others.

Paragraph 5

A decline of empathy and a rise in narcissism are exactly what we would expect to see in children who have little opportunity to play socially. Children cannot learn these social skills and values in

school, because school is an authoritarian, not a democratic setting. School **fosters** competition, not co-operation; and children there are not free to quit when others fail to respect their needs and wishes.

Question 9 Which of the following real-life scenarios best matches the definitions of empathy and narcissism, respectively, as explained in the passage?

A. Sahil overhears that his colleague, Priya, cannot afford to buy lunch for the day. He discreetly leaves some money on her desk. When Mohit sees his neighbour Ravi buy a brand-new car, he starts comparing his own life to Ravi's, feeling bitter about his perceived lack of success.

B. When Priya notices that her teammate Raj is overwhelmed by a project deadline, she steps in to assist. After speaking harshly to his younger brother, Raj spends the entire night pondering his harsh words earlier in the day.

C. Mrs. Sharma, a teacher, observes that Aarav is struggling with learning a concept. She carefully adapts her teaching style to the child's needs. On a group outing, Neha insists that they visit places she prefers, as they are on a restricted schedule.

D. Despite being unsuccessful at every attempt for the past four years, Karan keeps on taking further competitive exams. Reema realises she embarrassed her best friend Aditi in front of others. She avoids meeting her for days.

E. When Aditya overhears a conversation about an ancient civilisation, he spends the entire evening reading articles and watching documentaries on the topic. After topping her exams, Nisha starts talking only about her achievements in every gathering.

Question 10

Refer to the line: "There are lots of reasons for these changes but the effect, over the decades, has been a continuous and ultimately dramatic decline in children's opportunities to play and explore in their own chosen ways."

This line can conclude which of the paragraphs of the passage?

A. Second

B. Fourth

C. Third

D. Fifth

E. First

Question 11

Inference

Which of the following stands true about the author, based on the understanding of the passage?

I. The author might be a psychologist by profession.

II. He consistently had to juggle schooling and outdoor activities.

sufficient time ×

III. He is of the opinion that real-world challenges can impart far more valuable teachings than any textbook.

IV. He believes that children are not part of the decision-making process in schools.

A. III and IV

B. I, II, and IV

C. II, III, and IV

D. I, III, and IV

E. All I, II, III, and IV

Question 12

Which of the following groups of words can represent the author's tone throughout the passage?

A. informative, critical, speculative, sycophantic

B. critical, reflective, analytical, concerned

C. informative, analytical, apathetic, objective

D. analytical, sceptical, critical, nostalgic

E. informative, objective, incensed, belligerent

guess

flattery

retrospective

P1

C

Question 13

School Empathy

Playtime/Social

The passage provides sufficient information to answer which of the following questions?

not playing outdoor

I. What is the relationship between school and levels of empathy and narcissism in children?

II. What does the author propose doing to overcome boredom after school?

only

III. What sole factor contributed to increased free time for children in the past?

A. Only III

B

B. Only II and III

C. Only I and III

D. Only I and II

E. All I, II, and III

Question 14

As per the passage, we can conclude that a campaign for a longer school day and school year for school children in the US would be met with:

A. mild criticism from the author.

B. sharp criticism from the author. B

C. mild acceptance from the author.

D. enthusiastic acceptance from the author.

E. impassive objectivity from the author.

Question 15

Which of the following idioms most accurately conveys the parents' frame of mind with respect to children?

A. In the dark not aware

B. Hit the nail on the head

C. Let the cat out of the bag

D. Out of the woods

E. Under the weather

A

School **fosters** competition, not co-operation; and children there are not free to quit when others fail to respect their needs and wishes.

Practice

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Question 16

Which of the following is opposite in meaning to the highlighted word in the passage?

ED → Difficult

Easy

Perfection

ED

Exam Difficult

Easy

A. galvanise

B. fortify

C. precipitate

D. espouse

E. inhibit

stop